

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-IV

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INSTRUCTIONS

1. There are THIRTEEN questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. Questions 1-5 contain two 10-mark parts. Questions 6-7 carry 10 marks each.
3. Questions 8-12 are 20-mark case studies; Question 13 is a 30-mark case study.
4. Use ethical concepts, stakeholder analysis, options, reasons and safeguards.

Q1. (a) "Values without institutional support will soon be weakened and dissipated." Examine this proposition with reference to Indian public administration. (b) Distinguish ethics from morality. Why does the distinction matter to a public servant?

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q2. (a) "Refugees should not be turned back to the country where they would face persecution or human right violation." Examine the statement with reference to ethical dimension being violated by the nation claiming to be democratic with open society. (b) Discuss the claim that emotional intelligence is the ability to make emotions work for you rather than against you, with reference to a civil servant's capacity to manage conflicting personal and professional duties during a crisis.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q3. (a) "Corruption is the manifestation of the failure of core values in the society." In your opinion, what measures can be adopted to uplift the core values in the society? (b) Besides domain knowledge, a public official needs innovativeness and creativity of a high order while resolving ethical dilemmas. Discuss with suitable example.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q4. (a) "Non-performance of duty by a public servant is a form of corruption". Do you agree with this view? Justify your answer. (b) Administrative AI should support judgment without becoming an unanswerable final decision-maker. Examine with suitable safeguards.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q5. (a) "Life doesn't make any sense without interdependence. We need each other, and the sooner we learn that, it is better for us all." - Erik Erikson. What does this quotation mean to you? (b) Apart from intellectual competency and moral qualities, empathy and compassion are some of the other vital attributes that facilitate the civil servants to be more competent in tackling the crucial issues or taking critical decisions. Explain with suitable illustrations.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q6. Explain how the bona fides test protects honest administrative risk-taking without creating immunity for negligent or corrupt decisions.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q7. Examine how the three components of attitude can be targeted differently in civil-service training to reduce bias in service delivery.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q8. A successful marketing executive in an apparel company is accused by a woman employee of workplace sexual harassment. Management initially ignores her grievance and later offers money for withdrawal of both the complaint and FIR, along with a written declaration exonerating the executive. Identify the ethical issues and the options available to the woman employee. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q9. You chair a tender committee for essential hospital equipment. A technically strong preferred vendor has supplied the department reliably for years, but its local agent is your former business partner and the tender specifications closely match that vendor's product. Evaluate the options and recommend action. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q10. Sunil, a young civil servant confronting an illegal sand-mining mafia supported by local functionaries and insiders, faces threats to himself and surveillance of his family. Identify his options, critically evaluate them, and select the most appropriate course of action. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q11. As a hospital administrator during an infectious COVID-19 crisis, identify and justify the criteria for deploying clinical and non-clinical staff, and examine whether the justification would differ in a private hospital. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q12. A State proposes to integrate Citizens' Charters, a grievance portal and its public-service-guarantee law into one service-delivery system. Develop a lawful, citizen-centred and accountable model. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q13. Parmal is a small but underdeveloped district. It has rocky terrain that is not suitable for agriculture, though some subsistence agriculture is being done on small plots of land. The area receives adequate rainfall and has an irrigation canal flowing through it. Amria, its administrative centre, is a medium sized town. It houses a large district hospital, an Industrial Training Institute and some privately owned skill training centres. It has all the facilities of a district headquarters. A trunk railway line passes approximately 50 kilometres from Amria. Its poor connectivity is a major reason for the absence of any major industry therein. The state government offers a 10 years tax holiday as an incentive to new industry. In 2010 Anil, an industrialist, decided to take benefits to set up Amria Plastic Works (APW) in Noora village, about 20 km from Amria. While the factory was being built, Anil hired the required key labour and got them trained at the skill training centres at Amria. This act of his made the key personnel very loyal to APW. APW started production in 2011 with the labour drawn fully from Noora village. The villagers were very happy to get employment near their homes and were motivated by the key personnel to meet the production targets with high quality. APW started making large profits, a sizeable portion of which was used to improve the quality of life in Noora. By 2016, Noora could boast of a greener village and a renovated village temple. Anil liaised with the local MLA to increase the frequency of the bus services to Amria. The government also opened a primary health care centre and primary school at Noora in buildings constructed by APW. APW used its CSR funds to set up women's self-help groups, subsidize primary education to the village children and procure an ambulance for use by its employees and the needy. In 2019, there was a minor fire in APW. It was quickly extinguished as fire safety protocols were in place in the factory. Investigations revealed that the factory had been using electricity in excess of its authorized capacity. This was soon rectified. The next year, due to a nationwide lockdown, the requirement of production fell for four months. Anil decided that all employees would be paid regularly. He employed them to plant trees and improve the village habitat. APW had developed a reputation of high quality production and a motivated workforce. Critically analyse the story of APW and state the ethical issues involved. Do you consider APW as a role model for development of backward areas? Give reasons.

[30 marks | 350 words]

END OF PAPER